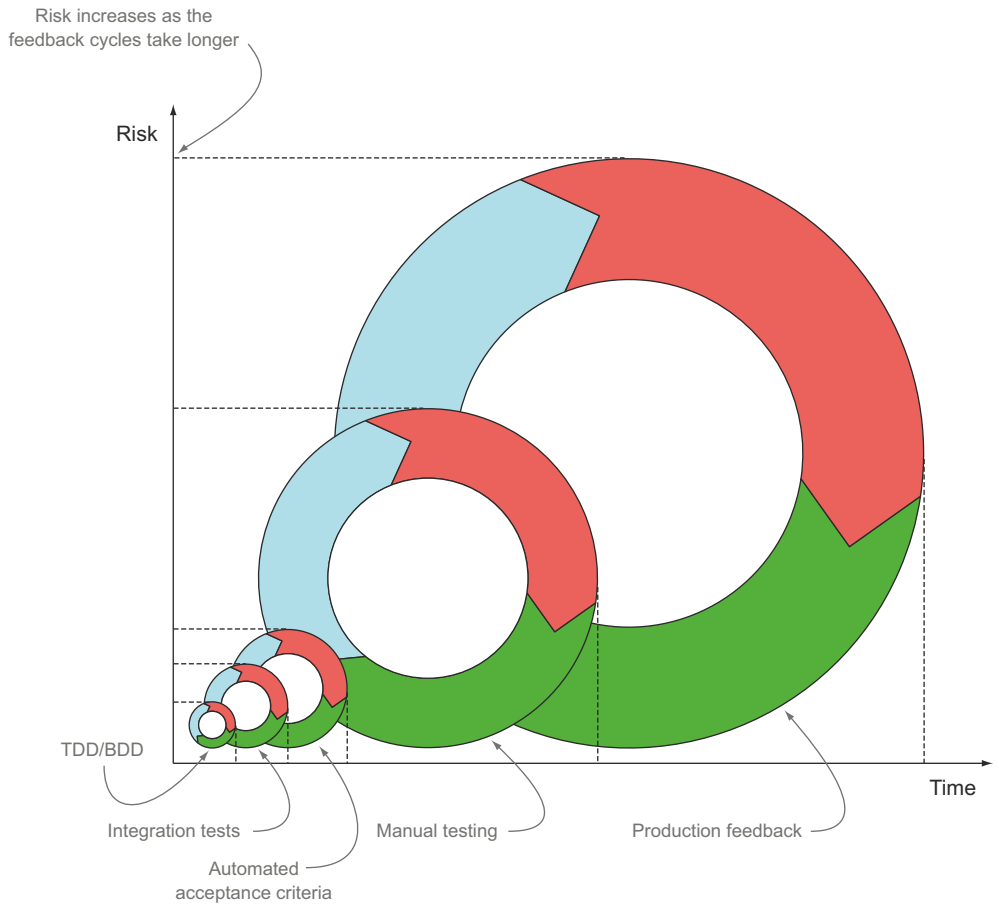


Figure 12.3 All forms of tests provide feedback, but the longer a test takes to provide feedback, the higher the risk.

testing, developers might need to wait for days, weeks, or even months to get this same feedback (see figure 12.3).

The principal goal of continuous integration (CI) is to provide fast feedback on the state of the build process. A CI server is an application that continually monitors a project's source code repository for changes. Whenever a change is committed to version control, the CI server kicks off a build to compile and test this version of the application. This ensures that all of the automated tests are run against each new version of the code base. If anything goes wrong, the team is immediately notified. In teams that practice CI well, the status of the build is taken very seriously, and if a build breaks, the developer responsible will immediately stop work and fix the problem.

Figure 12.4 illustrates the results of a set of automated acceptance criteria run under Cucumber, as displayed on Jenkins, a popular open source CI server (http://jenkins-ci.org/).